

who you respect, and someone subordinate who's doing the job you did . . . better than you did it."

A mentor is valuable because they've already been where you want to go. They can take you under their wing, share past experience, and guide you. The alternative is to learn everything by trial and error. Unfortunately, finding a good mentor who has an interest in helping, teaching, and guiding you on your journey is usually not easy. So what can you do?

Let's return to the example of Brad and Jonathan building their relationship before launching *ChooseFI*. Jonathan had no experience with blogging or podcasting before they started the podcast. He valued Brad as a mentor, so he focused on adding value for Brad when he pitched him on partnering to start *ChooseFI*. Here's how he described his thought process in a conversation on the podcast: "You can't go to that person that has it completely all figured out. They've got a complete business model that's running. They don't need you or have time for you. There was room in Brad's life for someone to help introduce a new project and take it to the next level. He wasn't at the finish line yet. He was really close, but he wasn't at the finish line yet. I had to bring something to the table, so I brought an idea and I brought sweat equity."